

BERO TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED

PRIVACY POLICY

1. Introduction and DPDP Act Compliance Framework

Bero Technologies Private Limited respects Your privacy and is unequivocally committed to protecting Your digital personal data. This Privacy Policy is drafted and published in strict compliance with the **Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (DPDP Act)**, the Information Technology Act, 2000, and the Information Technology (Reasonable Security Practices and Procedures and Sensitive Personal Data or Information) Rules, 2011.

This Policy acts as a mandatory notice outlining our practices regarding the collection, processing, retention, and security of Your data. By acting through a clear affirmative action (e.g., explicitly ticking an unchecked consent box during registration), You provide Your free, specific, informed, and unconditional consent for Bero (acting as the "Data Fiduciary") to process Your personal data.

2. Categories of Digital Personal Data Collected

To operate the hyper-local marketplace and power the computational matching engines, Bero collects the following itemized categories of data:

Data Category	Specific Elements Collected and Processed
Identity & Profile Data	Full name, age, gender, profile photograph, Aadhaar/PAN details (exclusively for KYC verification of Service Professionals), email address, and mobile phone number.
Geospatial Data (Location)	Real-time GPS coordinates, which are mathematically mapped to the H3 Hierarchical Hexagonal Index. This is critically necessary for proximity dispatch, real-time tracking, and the calculation of spatial decay supply modeling.
Financial & Payment Data	Bank account details, UPI IDs, Escrow transaction histories, and billing addresses. This data is processed securely through PCI-DSS compliant gateways; Bero does not store raw credit card numbers.
Device & Usage Data	IP address, device model, operating system, network status, app interaction logs, and offline-sync CRDT (Conflict-Free Replicated Data Type) logs.
Reputation Data	Reviews, ratings, Bayesian Truth Serum (BTS) inputs, cancellation frequencies, and algorithmic performance metrics.

3. Purpose Limitation and Lawful Processing

Your data is processed strictly according to the principle of purpose limitation for the following operational necessities, aligned with the DPDP Act:

- 3.1. Algorithmic Dispatch:** Utilising exact location data and reputation metrics to execute the bipartite graph matching algorithm, ensuring Service Requests are allocated to the most suitable Service Professional.
- 3.2. Dynamic Pricing Generation:** Aggregating and anonymising location and usage data to calculate market tightness and Bayesian elasticity, which form the core inputs for the surge pricing models.
- 3.3. Trust, Safety, and KYC:** Processing identity and background verification data to prevent fraud, ensure ecosystem safety, and maintain the integrity of the Bayesian Reputation system.
- 3.4. Financial Settlement:** Facilitating the secure transfer of funds between Clients and Service Professionals through the RBI-compliant Escrow Account architecture.

4. Consent Management and Data Principal Rights

In accordance with Chapter III of the DPDP Act 2023, You (referred to legally as the "Data Principal") possess the following enforceable rights:

- 4.1. Right to Access:** You may request a comprehensive summary of the personal data currently being processed by Bero, along with the identities of all third-party Data Processors with whom it has been shared.
- 4.2. Right to Correction:** You possess the right to request the immediate update, correction, or completion of any inaccurate or misleading personal data.
- 4.3. Right to Erasure (Right to be Forgotten):** You may request the deletion of Your personal data when it is no longer necessary for the purpose for which it was collected, provided there are no overriding legal retention mandates (e.g., financial record-keeping laws).
- 4.4. Right to Withdraw Consent:** You may withdraw Your consent for data processing at any time through the in-app Consent Manager. The process for withdrawal is designed to be as easy as providing consent. *Note: Withdrawing consent for core data processing (such as location tracking) will render Bero unable to provide its matching services to You.*
- 4.5. Right to Nominate:** You possess the right to nominate another individual to exercise Your data rights in the event of Your death or incapacity.

5. Data Retention Lifecycle

Bero adheres to strict data minimisation and storage limitation principles as mandated by the DPDP Act.

- 5.1. Routine personal data is retained only for as long as Your account remains active or as strictly necessary to fulfill the operational purposes outlined above.
- 5.2. Financial transaction logs, Escrow settlement records, and KYC documentation are retained for a minimum of seven (7) years to comply with the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002, and RBI regulatory mandates.
- 5.3. Upon the expiry of the statutory retention period, Your data is either permanently erased or subjected to cryptographic anonymisation, rendering it irreversibly non-identifiable.

6. Third-Party Sharing and Cross-Border Transfers

- 6.1. Bero explicitly does not sell Your personal data to third-party data brokers or advertising agencies. We only share data with verified "Data Processors" who are strictly bound by robust Data Processing Agreements (DPAs) and confidentiality clauses. These processors include:
 - Cloud service infrastructure providers (e.g., Supabase, AWS) hosting our backend architecture.
 - Authorised Scheduled Commercial Banks handling the Escrow Account ledgers.
 - Accredited third-party background verification agencies.
- 6.2. **Cross-Border Transfer Clause:** All critical financial, payment, and KYC data is stored exclusively on servers physically located within the territorial borders of India, in strict and absolute compliance with the RBI Data Localisation Circular (2018). Non-critical telemetry data may be processed globally, strictly subject to the transfer restrictions and negative lists published by the Central Government of India under the DPDP Act.

7. Data Security Measures

Bero implements robust administrative, technical, and physical security safeguards to protect Your digital personal data from unauthorised access, alteration, disclosure, or breach. This includes AES-256 encryption for data at rest, Transport Layer Security (TLS 1.3) for data in transit, strict Role-Based Access Controls (RBAC), and periodic Data Protection Impact Assessments (DPIA). In the event of a personal data breach, Bero is legally obligated to notify the Data Protection Board of India and the affected Data Principals in accordance with statutory timelines.

8. Protection of Children's Data

Bero does not knowingly collect, process, or track the personal data of individuals under the age of eighteen (18). If We discover that a minor has registered on the Platform without verifiable parental consent, We will immediately purge such data from our servers and terminate the account, ensuring strict compliance with the DPDP Act's prohibitions on tracking or behaviorally monitoring children.

9. Grievance Officer Contact Information

In strict compliance with the DPDP Act 2023 and the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules 2020, Bero has appointed a dedicated Grievance Officer stationed in India to address Your privacy concerns, facilitate Data Principal rights requests, and manage dispute redressal.

Name: [To be assigned]

Designation: Data Protection Officer & Grievance Officer

Email Address: grievance@bero.in

Physical Address: Bero Technologies Pvt. Ltd., New Delhi, India.

Users may contact the Grievance Officer regarding any data breaches, consent withdrawal requests, or general privacy inquiries. We guarantee a preliminary acknowledgment within 48 hours. If You are unsatisfied with the resolution provided by the Grievance Officer, You possess the statutory right to escalate the complaint directly to the **Data Protection Board of India**.